

PHASE 4 SLATE (2021–2024): 9 FILMS + 2 DISNEY+ SERIES

The Secret Wars Saga, Part One: "Everything Dies"

Status:  All 9 films and 2 series are filled.

FILMS (the main story)

#	Title	Release date	Owner	Dossier
1	X-Men: Second Genesis	Friday, July 9, 2021	The X-Men ensemble (real actors)	 complete
2	Namor the Sub-Mariner	Friday, November 5, 2021	Tenoch Huerta	 complete
3	Doctor Strange: The Black Priests	Friday, May 6, 2022	Benedict Cumberbatch	 complete
4	The Inhumans	Friday, July 8, 2022	Anson Mount	 complete
5	Spider-Man: Kraven's Last Hunt	Friday, December 16, 2022	Tom Holland	 complete
6	Thor: The Halls of Hel	Friday, May 5, 2023	Esther Smalley	 complete
7	Black Panther: Doomwar	Friday, November 3, 2023	Letitia Wright	 complete
8	Eternals	Friday, May 3, 2024	The Eternals ensemble (Richard Madden & Gemma Chan lead)	 complete
9	Fantastic Four: Solve Everything	Friday, November 1, 2024	The FF ensemble (Pedro Pascal leads)	 complete

DISNEY+ SERIES (limit: 2 this phase)

#	Title	Premiere	Owner	Dossier
S1	Ms. Marvel (8 episodes)	Wed, June 7 → Wed, July 26, 2023 (weekly)	Iman Vellani	✓ complete
S2	Daredevil: Born Again (9 episodes)	Wed, March 6 → Wed, May 1, 2024 (weekly)	Charlie Cox	✓ complete

REAL-WORLD CONTEXT (locked)

- **The COVID-19 pandemic** (real history) closed U.S. theaters in **March 2020**. There's **no MCU film in 2020**, which lines up with the gap between the two sagas.
- In 2021 theaters are **reopening slowly**. Disney releases films **in theaters and on Disney+ Premier Access** on the same day (as it did in the real world in 2021).
- **In the MCU's own world there is no pandemic**, as in the real Marvel films. The pandemic affects **the business, not the story**.

PHASE 4 FILM #1: X-MEN: SECOND GENESIS

- **Release date: Friday, July 9, 2021. Why not the first Friday in May:** in 2021 theaters are still reopening, and in the real world Marvel **moved its first post-pandemic film to July 9, 2021** for the same reason. It's the realistic call, and it gives the saga's first film a proper summer opening.
- **Comics: *Giant-Size X-Men* #1** (1975), "Second Genesis!", the **all-new, all-different X-Men**.

PHASE 4 FILM #2: NAMOR THE SUB-MARINER

- **Character:** Namor McKenzie, the Sub-Mariner. First appearance: **Marvel Comics #1** (October 1939), Bill Everett. He's **the first Marvel superhero ever published**, older than Captain America.
- **Why second: Namor is at the center of Hickman's saga.** He's the Illuminati member who **agrees to destroy other Earths and founds the Cabal** with Doom's knowledge. His grief and pride have to be established **before** the Incursions start. His film ends with **the first Incursion over Wakanda**.
- **Release date: Friday, November 5, 2021.** Marvel's fall slot. Theaters have mostly recovered by now, so this is a **theatrical-exclusive release** with a 45-day window before Disney+.
- ⚠️ **Real history:** Chadwick Boseman died on August 28, 2020. ✓ **Locked:** T'Challa died in the MCU in 2020, off-screen, of illness. **Shuri (Letitia Wright) is Black Panther**, as on 616, and holds Wakanda's seat among the Illuminati.

PHASE 4 FILM #3: DOCTOR STRANGE: THE BLACK PRIESTS

- **Character:** Doctor Strange, as a **member of the Illuminati**.
- **Why third:** Hickman's *New Avengers* is the Illuminati story. Strange is the one who **pays the highest price**: he makes a dark bargain for power and **destroys an entire Earth**. His film is where *Everything Dies* gets real, including **Captain America's mind wipe**.
- **Release date:** Friday, May 6, 2022. The first Friday in May, back in its traditional slot now that theaters have recovered.

PHASE 4 FILM #4: THE INHUMANS

- **Characters:** Black Bolt and the Inhuman Royal Family. First appearance: *Fantastic Four* #45 (December 1965), Lee & Kirby.
- **Why fourth:** Black Bolt is an Illuminati member, and Hickman's **Terrigen Bomb** (*Infinity*, 2013) puts Inhumans all over the planet, changing the MCU's world permanently. It also sets up **Kamala Khan** (the Jersey City cocoon).
- **Release date:** Friday, July 8, 2022. Mid-summer.

PHASE 4 FILM #5: SPIDER-MAN: KRAVEN'S LAST HUNT

- **Release date:** Friday, December 16, 2022. A holiday event release, the same slot the real *Spider-Man: No Way Home* used in 2021.
- **Comics:** *ASM Annual* #21 (the wedding) and "Kraven's Last Hunt" (1987).

PHASE 4 SERIES #1: MS. MARVEL (Disney+)

- **Character:** Kamala Khan / Ms. Marvel. First appearance: *Captain Marvel* vol. 7 #14 (2013); her own series is *Ms. Marvel* vol. 3 #1 (2014), G. Willow Wilson & Adrian Alphona.
- **Why she's the first series:**
- **She's the direct payoff of *The Inhumans*:** her cocoon was in its post-credit scene.
- **She's the best street-level, ground-floor view of a world changed by Terrigen,** and the Incursions show up in her own fan fiction.
- **She suits the series format:** family, school and Jersey City need **episodes**, not two hours.
- On 616 she **becomes an Avenger**, which is seeded for later.
- **Schedule:** 8 episodes, Wednesdays, June 7 to July 26, 2023, 48–56 minutes each. Disney+ released new episodes on Wednesdays at the time.

PHASE 4 FILM #6: THOR: THE HALLS OF HEL

- **Release date:** Friday, May 5, 2023. The first Friday in May.
- **Comics:** Simonson's *Thor* #360–362: **Hela's curse** and **Skurge at Gjallerbru** (promised in *Thor: The Twilight Sword*).
- **In memory:** Ray Stevenson (Volstagg) died on May 21, 2023, sixteen days after release.

PHASE 4 FILM #7: BLACK PANTHER: DOOMWAR

- **Release date:** Friday, November 3, 2023. Marvel's fall slot.
- **Comics:** *Doomwar* (2010) and Shuri's *Black Panther* vol. 5 (2009). **Doom invades Wakanda**, and Shuri makes Wakanda's vibranium inert to stop him.

PHASE 4 SERIES #2: DAREDEVIL: BORN AGAIN (Disney+)

- **Character:** Matt Murdock / Daredevil. First appearance: *Daredevil* #1 (April 1964), Stan Lee & Bill Everett.
- **Why he's the second series:**
- "Born Again" (1986) is one of the greatest Marvel stories ever told, and it's built for long-form television.
- It launches the Bible's R-rated street-level label (TV-MA), so street heroes are never watered down.
- It brings Cap down to street level, where he starts seeing what the heroes at the top are hiding.
- **Schedule:** 9 episodes, Wednesdays, March 6 to May 1, 2024, 52–60 minutes each.

PHASE 4 FILM #8: ETERNALS

- **Characters:** The Eternals. First appearance: *The Eternals* #1 (July 1976), Jack Kirby.
- **Why eighth:**
- **The Celestials** are the cosmic engineers the **Beyonders slaughter** on 616 (*Time Runs Out*). The audience has to **meet them before they die**.
- **Thanos is an Eternal of Titan**, and this film brings in his brother **Eros (Starfox)** and **reawakens Thanos's story**.
- It's Jack Kirby's great cosmic epic.
- **Release date:** Friday, May 3, 2024. The first Friday in May.
-  **Casting:** Salma Hayek (Ajak), Lauren Ridloff (Makkari) and Lia McHugh (Sprite). As with Thor and Hawkeye, **they're the same 616 characters, and have always been female**.

PHASE 4 FILM #9: FANTASTIC FOUR: SOLVE EVERYTHING (Phase 4 finale)

- **Characters:** The Fantastic Four, with Franklin and Valeria, and Doom as an ally.
- **Why they end Phase 4:** on 616, Hickman's *Fantastic Four* is the foundation of *Secret Wars*. The Council of Reeds shows the audience the **multiverse** and that **every universe is dying**. Johnny's death gives the phase an emotional ending. The **post-credit scene**, Cap remembering, starts *Time Runs Out*.
- **Release date:** Friday, November 1, 2024. Marvel's fall slot.